The spatial periodicity of the wave is

$$\lambda = \frac{2\pi}{k} \text{ in m}$$

Then,

At $t = 0$ s $\quad y(x, 0) = y(x + \lambda, 0)$ and

At any time t, $y(x, t) = y(x + \lambda, t)$

EXAMPLE 11.14

The wavelength of two sine waves are λ_1 = 1m and λ_2 = 6m. Calculate the corresponding wave numbers.

Solution

$$k_1 = \frac{2\pi}{1} = 6.28 \text{ rad m}^{-1}$$

$$k_2 = \frac{2\pi}{6} = 1.05 \text{ rad m}^{-1}$$

(b) Time variation graph

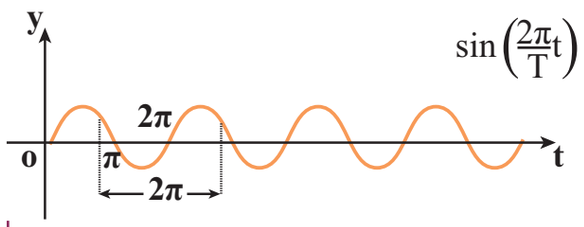


Figure 11.25 Graph of sinusoidal function $y = A \sin(\omega t)$

By keeping the position fixed, the change in displacement with respect to time is plotted. Let us consider a sinusoidal graph, $y = A \sin(\omega t)$ as shown in the Figure 11.25, where ω is angular frequency of the wave which measures how quickly wave oscillates in time or number of cycles per second.

The temporal periodicity or time period is

$$T = \frac{2\pi}{\omega} \Rightarrow \omega = \frac{2\pi}{T}$$

The angular frequency is related to frequency f by the expression $\omega = 2\pi f$, where the frequency f is defined as the number of oscillations made by the medium particle per second. Since inverse of frequency is time period, we have,

$$T = \frac{1}{f} \text{ in seconds}$$

This is the time taken by a medium particle to complete one oscillation. Hence, we can define the speed of a wave (wave speed, v) as the distance traversed by the wave per second

$$v = \frac{\lambda}{T} = \lambda f \text{ in m s}^{-1}$$

which is the same relation as we obtained in equation (11.4).

11.6.4 Particle velocity and wave velocity

In a plane progressive harmonic wave, the constituent particles in the medium oscillate simple harmonically about their equilibrium positions. When a particle is in motion, the rate of change of displacement at any instant of time is defined as velocity of the particle at that instant of time. This is known as particle velocity.

$$v_P = \frac{dy}{dt} \text{ m s}^{-1} \qquad (11.41)$$

But $\quad y(x, t) = A \sin(k x - \omega t) \qquad (11.42)$

Therefore, $\frac{dy}{dt} = -\omega A \cos(k x - \omega t) \qquad (11.43)$

Similarly, we can define velocity (here speed) for the travelling wave (or progressive wave). In order to determine the velocity of a progressive wave, let us consider a progressive wave (shown in Figure 11.23) moving towards right. This can be mathematically represented as a sinusoidal wave. Let P be any point on the phase of the wave and y_p be its displacement with respect

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